

Yuki Tanaka

VP OF DESIGN / HEAD OF PRODUCT DESIGN

Email: yuki.tanaka@uxdesign.pro

Phone: +1 (415) 672-0049

Location: San Francisco, CA 94105

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/yuki-tanaka-pro](https://www.linkedin.com/in/yuki-tanaka-pro)

13+

Years Experience

4

Companies Served

4

Certifications

6

Skill Groups

6

Awards

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Award-winning design executive with 13+ years crafting transformative digital experiences used by 200M+ people globally. Led product design at Airbnb, Apple, and Figma, building and scaling world-class design systems, research programs, and design organizations. Expert in 0→1 product design, design systems architecture, accessibility-first design, and building inclusive design cultures. Recipient of Fast Company Innovation by Design Gold (2023), Webby Award Best UX (2022), and Apple Design Award (2017). MFA from Rhode Island School of Design.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

DESIGN DISCIPLINES

Interaction Design

Visual Design

UX Research

Design Systems

Motion Design

Service Design

Accessibility

LEADERSHIP

Design Org Building

Creative Direction

Roadmap Ownership

Cross-functional Partnership

Design Critique

RESEARCH METHODS

Usability Testing

Journey Mapping

Jobs-to-be-Done

Diary Studies

A/B Testing

Quant Research

TOOLS

Figma (Expert)

Framer (Expert)

Principle (Advanced)

After Effects (Advanced)

Sketch (Expert)

ProtoPie

PROTOTYPING/CODE

React (Proficient)

HTML/CSS

TypeScript (Basic)

Storybook

Lottie

ANALYTICS

Amplitude

Mixpanel

FullStory

Hotjar

Heap

Maze

UserTesting

CERTIFICATIONS

Nielsen Norman UX Certified (2020)

Google UX Design Professional

WORK EXPERIENCE

VP of Product Design Airbnb · San Francisco, CA

Apr 2021 - Present

- ▶ Lead 75-person product design organization spanning Homes, Experiences, and Host Platform; oversee UX Research (18 researchers), Visual Design, Motion Design, and Design Engineering teams
- ▶ Launched Airbnb's most significant redesign in 8 years ('Reimagined Airbnb', 2023); 24% increase in search-to-book conversion, \$840M incremental GMV in year 1
- ▶ Built Airbnb Design System (ADS) 3.0 — 1,800+ components, full dark mode, 12 brand themes, motion tokens; adopted by 320 engineers, reducing design-to-code time by 58%
- ▶ Established Accessibility Design Center of Excellence: achieved WCAG 2.1 AAA on all 12 core user journeys; first major travel platform to achieve AAA at scale
- ▶ Scaled design organization from 38 to 75 while maintaining design quality; built structured IC and management career ladders, reducing attrition from 22% to 7%
- ▶ Launched Airbnb's first dedicated AI UX research program studying user trust, explainability, and AI-assisted booking recommendations

Stack: Figma, Framer, Lottie, Storybook, React, TypeScript, Maze, FullStory, Amplitude

Design Director, Product Design Figma · San Francisco, CA

Jul 2018 - Mar 2021

- ▶ Led Figma's core product design team of 28 designers across Editor, Files, Prototyping, and Developer Handoff surfaces
- ▶ Shipped FigJam (collaborative whiteboard) — designed core UX from 0→1, launched 2021; reached 3M MAU in 6 months
- ▶ Created Figma's internal Spectrum Design System (1,200+ components); became model for Figma's public design system offerings
- ▶ Grew design team from 8 to 28 designers; built first dedicated design research function with 5 researchers

Stack: Figma, Principle, After Effects, React, Storybook

Senior UX Designer Apple Inc. · Cupertino, CA

Aug 2013 - Jun 2018

- ▶ Core UX designer on iOS System Experience team contributing to iOS 10, 11, 12, 13 (shipped to 1.2B+ devices)
- ▶ Led iOS Control Center redesign (iOS 11): most-used iOS power feature, 14B+ weekly interactions, Apple Design Award 2017
- ▶ Designed Apple Maps transit navigation for 22 cities launch; reduced user error rate by 34% through contextual wayfinding system
- ▶ Filed 3 design patents on gesture-based interaction patterns adopted across iOS/iPadOS

Stack: Sketch, Keynote, Xcode, Motion, Swift (Prototyping)

UI/UX Designer IDEO · San Francisco, CA

Jun 2011 - Jul 2013

- ▶ Human-centered design consultant for Fortune 500 clients across healthcare, banking, and retail sectors
- ▶ Led 8 design sprint engagements resulting in 4 launched products generating \$90M+ combined revenue

Stack: Sketch, InVision, Balsamiq, Design Research methods

(2021)

Interaction Design Foundation
– Advanced (2019)

CPACC Accessibility
Certification (2022)

EDUCATION

MFA, Interaction Design
Rhode Island School of
Design (RISD)

Year: 2011

Valedictorian · Full Fellowship

B.A., Fine Arts &
Cognitive Science

University of California,
Berkeley

Year: 2009

Highest Honors

LANGUAGES

EnglishNative

JapaneseNative (C2)

FrenchConversational (B2)

MandarinBasic (A2)

AWARDS

🏆 Fast Company Innovation by
Design – Gold (2023)

🏆 Webby Award – Best UX
Design (2022)

🏆 HOW International Design
Award – Gold (2021)

🏆 Apple Design Award (2017)

🏆 AIGA 50 Books / 50 Covers
(2019)

🏆 Core77 Award – Digital
Category (2018)

VOLUNTEERING

• Design for America – Mentor
(2016–Present)

• ADPList – Design Mentor
(1,200+ sessions)

• RISD Career Advisory Board
(2020–Present)

• Women in Product Design – Co-
founder Chicago chapter

CONTACT

✉ yuki.tanaka@uxdesign.pro

☎ +1 (415) 672-0049

△ 188 Spear Street, San
Francisco, CA 94105

🌐 LinkedIn Profile

🔗 GitHub Profile

KEY PROJECTS

Airbnb 2023
Redesign

2022–2023

Led company-wide UX/visual overhaul. 24% booking conversion lift, \$840M incremental GMV. Featured in Fast Company, Wired, and Design Week as top redesign of 2023.

FigJam (0→1)

2020–2021

Designed FigJam collaborative whiteboard from concept to launch. Led user research, interaction design, information architecture. 3M MAU in 6 months post-launch.

iOS Control
Center (iOS 11)

2016–2017

Complete redesign enabling customization. Apple Design Award 2017. 700M+ iPhones updated. Highest user satisfaction feature in iOS 11 feedback surveys.

PUBLICATIONS, TALKS & MEDIA

► 'The Design System Field Guide' – Rosenfeld Media (2022), 14,000+ copies

► Speaker: Config (Figma Conference) 2021, 2022, 2023 Keynote

► Speaker: UX London Keynote 2020

► Guest: Design Better Podcast Ep. 190 (2022)

► Contributions to Nielsen Norman Group UX Research Library

PARSER EXTRACTION VERIFICATION

Field	Extracted Value	Format	Status
name	Yuki Tanaka	Full name string	✓ HIGH
email	yuki.tanaka@uxdesign.pro	RFC 5321 email	✓ HIGH
phone	+1 (415) 672-0049	E.164 / NANP	✓ HIGH
location	188 Spear Street, San Francisco, CA 94105	Address string	✓ HIGH
current_title	VP of Design / Head of Product Design	Job title string	✓ HIGH
current_employer	Airbnb	Company name	✓ HIGH
experience_years	13+	Integer+	✓ HIGH
work_history	4 positions with dates, bullets, stack	Array[Experience]	✓ HIGH
education	2 degrees	Array[Education]	✓ HIGH
certifications	4 certifications	Array[Cert]	✓ HIGH
skills	36 across 6 groups	Dict[Group:List]	✓ HIGH
languages	English(Native), Japanese(Native (C2)), French(Conversational (B2)), Mandarin(Basic (A2))	Lang:Level pairs	✓ HIGH
awards	6 named awards	Array[Award]	✓ HIGH
projects	3 projects with desc	Array[Project]	✓ HIGH
publications	5 publications/talks	Array[Publication]	✓ HIGH